

Starting Claim

- From the launch page, select "Begin Claim."
- Ask the repair facility to provide you with the last 6 of the VIN or the Contract number.
 - To avoid having to change date parameters, use the search options under "Advanced Search."
 - If the shop does not have the VIN or contract number, contract can be found by searching the customer name. Please note that this will take longer as it requires changing the date parameters.
 - In the event that the name does not match what we have on file, pay attention to the last name. If those match, it could be a family member. If nothing matches, advise the repair facility they will have to get in contact with the customer to confirm the name on the contract.
- Ask the repair facility what the current mileage is on the vehicle.
 - We must have the current mileage to begin a claim. If the shop is unable to provide current mileage, find out if it's because the odometer is broken or if it's due to an issue such as a dead battery.
 - If due to a dead battery, enter "99999" in the miles traveled and let the shop know we will not be able to authorize any work to the vehicle until we have an accurate mileage to determine if the contract is valid.

Gathering Repair Facility Information

The following fields must be filled out during initial intake. If the information requested is not available, notate as "**N/A**" or "**None.**"

- Repair Facility Name
- Address
- Zip Code
- City (Populates Automatically with Zip Code)
- State (Populates Automatically with Zip Code)
- Contact Name

- Email (Be sure to let the shop know they will receive email updates regarding the status of the claim. Also verify spelling.)
- Phone Number
- Fax Number
- Technician Name
- Shop Labor Rate (Inform shop of Contract Labor Rate Max)
- Engine Size (ex. 3.7 L)
- Modifications
- Shop Warranty
- Outside Parts (If asked, our parts come with a warranty through the supplier.)
- Miles Traveled (This is calculated using the "**Coverage Starting Mileage**" on the VSC Dec Page.)

Gathering Claim Information

Once all the repair facility information has been entered, drop down to the "**Repair Notes**" section of the "**Start Claim**" page.

- Ask the following: *"What was the first concern that brought the customer into your repair facility?"*
- Notate in the "**Repair Notes**" section accordingly using the following format:
 - c/s (customer states) complaint/cause/recommended correction
 - c/s complaint/cause/recommended correction
 - s/s (shop states) problem/cause/recommended correction
- Be sure to ask if the parts are original to the vehicle or if it looks like they have been previously replaced, especially when an alternator or starter is being replaced.
- If the claim is for an axle, make sure to ask the condition of the boot and notate if it is torn or damaged and notate.
- If the claim is for a transmission, make sure to ask if this is an automatic or manual transmission and notate.
- After the representative with the repair facility has provided all the issues, state the following:

"Thank you for that information. At this time, we will need an itemized estimate with the labor time, part numbers, and part prices for the repair. If there were any codes, please

make sure to list those as well. Also, please be sure to have the customer's name, VIN number and current mileage listed as this will help us get the estimate attached to the proper claim. You can email or fax the document to us and when it is received it will be put in line for review an Underwriter to review and reach back out to you. "

- Email: estimates@freedomwarranty.com
- Fax: (423) 661-7982

- Notate in the notes section that we are waiting on the RO.

Obtaining the Carfax

Once the claim has been started, a Carfax will need to be obtained and attached to the claim. This allows for Dealer Services to verify the contract and allows us to see if the vehicle has been maintained, if previous repairs have been made, etc.

To obtain a Carfax:

- Go to <https://www.carfaxbig.com/home/warranty>
- Enter in the VIN of the vehicle found on the "**Vehicle Info**" page of FWIS.
- Once the Carfax pulls up, verify the VIN is correct and save as a .pdf file. To do so:
 - Right click on the Carfax.
 - Choose "*Print*"
 - When the print box opens, change from the printer to "**Save as PDF.**"
 - Save as "Customer Last Name Carfax" and save to OneDrive files
 - i.e- Lawrence Carfax
- Attach Carfax to the attachments section found under "**Repair Notes.**"
- Notate in the "**Repair Notes**" section that you tagged a DS representative to review and change the disposition to "Dealer Services."

Opening A Trello Card

Trello is the collaboration board that helps us keep track of our open claims and what is needed as it moves between departments. After starting a claim, a Trello card will need to be opened. To start a Trello card:

- Go to the "**Claims- Contract Verification's**" board.
- Choose "+**Add Another Card.**"
- Enter in the date and your initials.
 - i.e.- 8/7/2020 SN
- Once in the card, locate the "**Description**" section at the top of the card. Enter the Customer Name, Client Name, and Claim Info.
 - i.e.- Customer Name: John Smith
Client Name: Freedom Warranty
Claim Number: 1041518200702
Policy Number: FWCPM041518
- Under the "**Activity**" section of the card, type in the text box your request/notes. Be sure that you tag the appropriate people!
 - i.e. - @aatnip- Please review Carfax
- If the contract is **Unpaid or Financed**:
- If **Unpaid**: tag the appropriate Dealer Services rep so they can reach out for payment.
- If **Financed**: Tag Accounting to ensure the customer is up to date on payment.
- Choose the proper label for the Trello Card.
 - Rep Name, Carfax Review, Financed, etc.
 - If the claim is for a Priority Dealer, be sure it has the *****Priority Dealer***** tag.

Updates from Dealer Services

Once Dealer Services has reviewed the documents we have provided, a few things can happen.

- No discrepancies
 - If there are no discrepancies found, the Dealer Services rep will tag you and let you know this. Go back into the claim and notate that there were no discrepancies per the DS rep.
 - If no RO is attached, change the disposition to **"Repair Order."**
 - If RO is attached, change the disposition of **"Underwriting"** and tag the appropriate underwriter.
- Request BOS
 - On occasion, Dealer Services will find a discrepancy between the contract and Carfax. At this point, the DS rep will tag you to let you know we are waiting on a Bill of Sale. Simply notate in the claim "Waiting on BOS" and change disposition to **"Bill of Sale."**
- Contract Cancellation
 - Should DS determine the contract is invalid, they will tag you and let you know that the contract has been cancelled. Notate the claim, cancel the claim on the back end, and call the shop to inform them the customer no longer has a valid contract and the claim is being cancelled.
 - If the shop pushes for more information, let them know the customer can call us with any questions they may have.

Customer Interviews and Maintenance Records

Customer Interview and Maintenance Records

With larger claims, it is sometimes beneficial for us to get more information from the customer. This is where a customer interview comes in. The customer interview allows us to speak with the customer and get their version of events regarding the failure. When performing a customer interview, the following questions are asked:

- 1) When did you purchase the vehicle?
- 2) When did you purchase your contract?
- 3) What happened that made you take your vehicle in for service?
- 4) When did you first notice the problem?
 - a) How many miles were on the vehicle at that time?

5) Did you have the vehicle towed to the repair facility?

a) If YES: What is the name of the towing company? (Was it the repair facility's tow truck?)

b) If YES: Please be sure to submit any tow receipts

6) If a Truck with no commercial coverage: You purchased the vehicle for work purposes?

7) If a Truck or SUB- What do you tow with the vehicle?

8) How many miles are on the vehicle now?

9) When was the oil last changed?

a) Ask the customer to submit any Maintenance Records that they may have for the vehicle.

10) Have you obtained a loaner or rental vehicle from the repair facility?

a) If YES: Rental? Loaner? Inform them of rental limits based on approved labor. We do not reimburse for loaner vehicles.

b) If YES: Please be sure to submit any receipts for rental costs.

Thank you very much for this information. We will process your claim and reach out to your repair facility with next steps.

Underwriting a Claim

Contract Validity

Each contract has a term that includes miles and time. (Unless unlimited mileage.)

- Check the miles traveled and ensure the customer is not over by miles.
- Check the elapsed time on the contract to ensure the customer is not over by time.
(If over by time, the system should show "Inactive" at the top of the claim.)
- Be sure the LOL has not been reached on the contract.

If any of the above show that the customer no longer has a valid contract, call the repair facility and let them know. Mark as non-covered on the back end and send the denial email to the agent letting them know the contract has expired.

Waiting Period Denials

You will notice that some contracts carry a 30 day and 1,000 mile waiting period. This means that the customer has to complete both actions before the contract is considered active.

- The customer must have the contract for 30 days **AND** must drive 1,000 miles.

The system will recognize if the waiting period has not been met and will notify you at the top of the screen. If you see that the vehicle has not met the waiting period, double check the mileage in the system against the mileage on the RO to ensure it is correct. Once you have determined that the contract is not out of the waiting period:

- Notate in the "Repair Notes" section- "DENIED- Waiting Period Not Met."
- Send the Denial email to the agent advising the waiting period has not been met. (CC: Claims Department, Sales Manager. BCC: Sales Director)
- Call the shop and advise that the customer has a waiting period that has not been met so we are unable to authorize repairs at this time.
 - The shop may try and get you to tell them exactly how many days/miles the customer is short by. DO NOT GIVE THIS INFORMATION if at all possible. This tends to start an argument not only with the customer but with the repair facility as well seeing as how they feel like we should just push it through. If you find yourself in this situation, you can let the repair facility know that our system will not allow us to move forward because the customer has not met the waiting period.
- Notate who you spoke with at the RF about the denial.
- On the "Finalize Claim" page, mark "Waiting-Period" and select "Denied" at the bottom of the page.
- Change the Disposition and Underwriter to Select
- Save your changes.
- Archive Trello Card

Review Repair Notes

At intake, the shop is to provide us with a list of concerns the the recommended repairs. Review those notes and determine what you believe to be approved and/or denied

based on the contract.

- Once you have reviewed the notes, open up the RO.
 - Even if you think the claim is denied, double check the RO to ensure the shop hasn't added in a repair that we don't know about. These could be covered components!
 - If you are unsure about what a part is, search the part number. Google can be a valuable tool to get a look at exactly what part the shop is requesting and can help you determine those internally lubricated components.

Denials for Non-Covered Components

By far, the easiest and most common denial is Non-Covered Components. How do you determine if a part is non-covered?

- Vital and Drive contracts provide specifically listed coverage. List means if the component requested **IS NOT** listed in Section 2: What's Covered, it is non-covered and therefore, denied.
- Complete and Complete Manufacturer's Extension contracts provide exclusionary coverage. This means if the part or component **IS** listed in Section 2 of the contract, it is non-covered and therefore, denied.
- Be sure to check for any upgrades that may have been purchased as these will provide extra coverage to the customer for components not regularly covered. Upgrades include:
 - Suspension Upgrade
 - Sensors Upgrade
 - Entertainment Package
 - Long Block Upgrade
 - Seals and Gaskets
- Once you have determined that this is, in fact, a Non-Covered Component:
 - Notate in the claim, "*Denied- Non-Covered Component*"

- Send Denial Email to Agent. (CC: Claims Department and Roger Gray. BCC: Sales)
 - Call the Repair Facility and advise that the claim has been denied as the requested components are non-covered under the customer's contract.
 - Notate in the claim who you spoke with about the denial.
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- On the "Finalize Claim" page, mark the claim as "Non-Covered" and select "Denied."
 - Change the Dispositions and Underwriters back to "Select."
 - Save your changes.
 - Archive Trello Card

Components Supported by the Contract

If you have determined that the requested repairs are supported by the contract, verify the following:

- Has this component been replaced before?
 - Search previous claims and Carfax to determine.
 - Is this still under another shop's warranty? If so, call the shop and advise. Mark as non-covered, deny, send denial email to agent.
- Is this part recall, class action lawsuit, warranty extension, etc?
 - If so, call the shop and advise your findings. Mark as non-covered, deny, and send denial email.
- Do the Maintenance Records line up with the recommended service schedule?
 - Can we fill in any gaps by looking at Carfax? Does it meet guidelines set for regarding the selling dealer having the oil changed or the oil being changed within the balance of an oil change before purchase?
 - If no, call the shop to advise. Mark as non-covered, deny, send denial email to agent.

Determining to Inspect

With larger claims such as engines and transmissions, an inspection can provide valuable information about the vehicle and failure. It can also provide us with an insight

as to if the customer has modified the vehicle in any way that would have contributed to the present failures or any even cause future issues. However, not every vehicle needs an inspection. Below are a few questions to ask yourself to determine if a vehicle may need an inspection

- Has the failure happened within a short period of time/distance? Is it possible for this particular component to fail within that amount of time or would there have had to have been an issue at purchase?
- Is this a major component such as an engine, transmission, turbo or timing chain?
- Does it appear that the vehicle has not been maintained by the customer?
- Is this a repair that is requiring all/most of the suspension components to be replaced?
- Is there anything that would lead you to believe that an inspection would be in our best interest?

If you determine that an inspection is needed, call the shop to advise. Let them know an ASE Certified Inspector will be out within 2 business days to inspect the vehicle and they will be given a call ahead of time to set up an appointment.

On the finalize claim page, put \$90.00 in the "Inspection Cost" field. Change your disposition to "Inspection Pending" and save your changes.

You may archive the Trello card while you wait for the inspection report.

Inspection Review

Inspection reports will consist of text, photos, and sometimes videos. It is incredibly important to review each component of the inspection to get a clear picture of that occurred to cause the vehicle to fail.

Pay attention to what the inspector says about the failure. Is this someone that would have pre-dated the start of the contract? Is this due to the time and miles on the vehicle? Are there signs of overheating? Abuse? Continued use?

While the inspectors do give us their opinion on the cause of failure, check the whole inspection to make sure we have enough evidence to back up a denial. If we don't have enough to back up a denial, then it may be that we have to approve the claim.

Underwriting

Once you have determined that a claim is valid and needs to be paid, follow these steps:

- Verify the labor requested via ProDemand.
 - Check the time to R&R as well as diagnosis
 - Does this part require programming?
 - Will it need an evac and recharge? Alignment?
 - Evac and Recharge- 1.4 hrs max
 - Alignment- \$69.95 max
- Check the parts prices against approved vendors.
 - As a general rule, if the repair facility is within \$100.00 of what we are able to get parts shipped for, go with their part. There are some exceptions.
- If quoting parts, make sure to notate as follows:
 - C and K Quote- Control Arm- 350.00/shipped=375.00
- Check the contract max labor rate. (This is determined by the Class of the Vehicle in the Contract)
 - A-D Regular- \$85.00
 - A-D Enhanced- \$110.00
 - E, X Regular- \$126.00
 - E, X Enhanced- \$165.00
- Calculate the approval numbers and format as follows:
 - Labor / Parts / Fluid / Align / Sublets / Total / Pay Shop

- Note: Fluid, Align, and Sublets will not be on all claims.

- Make a payment cover sheet with provided template
 - Be sure this includes the correct claim information and correct payment amount.
 - Save the cover sheet as a PDF and attach to the claim.
- Call the repair facility to review approval numbers.
 - This will be your opportunity to negotiate with the repair facility on parts prices if needed.
 - Advise that the customer would be responsible for any taxes, shop fees, and anything other than what was discussed on this call.
 - Confirm if they would like the cover sheet faxed or emailed.
- If the repair facility requests that we ship in the parts, they will only be paid for the labor less the customer's deductible. Advise the repair facility of the updated amount that will be paid to them and create a new spread sheet that reflects this payable amount.
- If there is no answer when you call, leave a voicemail and follow up with an approval email. Make sure to include contact information for any questions and attach the payment cover sheet.
- Send the payment cover sheet
- Enter in the correct amounts for:
 - Purchased Parts (if we ordered) on Start Claim Page
 - Labor and/or Parts on Start Claim Page
 - Diagnostic Time (if applicable) on Start Claim Page
 - Labor Time on Start Claim Page
 - Labor Rate on Start Claim Page
 - Deductible Applied (if applicable) on Start Claim Page

- Paid this Claim on Finalize Claim Page (should Match with Actual Claim amount on same page)
- Mar the claim as "Covered" on Finalize Claim page.
- Update the parts section just above the "Repair Notes" section
- Change the disposition to "Final Invoice."
- Save your changes.

Reimbursements

There are a few situations in which the customer would need to be reimbursed.

- Towing
- Rental
- Repairs Done Prior to Authorization

No matter the situation, in order for the reimbursement to be considered we must have a paid receipt.

- When processing a reimbursement for towing, verify there is a paid receipt and approve based on contract.
- When processing a reimbursement for rental, verify the labor hours approved on the claim. If it meets contract limits, verify there is a paid receipt and approve according to contract.
- When processing a reimbursement for a customer that had repairs done prior to authorization, underwrite as a normal claim unless it is a larger claim such as an engine that would require inspection.

Sending Claims for Payment

Sending Claims For Payment

- Upload the final invoice to the portal.
- Verify that all numbers match.
- Approval numbers in notes

- Numbers on the front and back end
- Number on cover sheet.
- Claim information on cover sheet.
 - If any of this information is incorrect, send back to underwriter to correct.

- Check that the final invoice is signed.
 - If not, call the shop request the signed final.

- Change the disposition to "Awaiting Payment."

- Mark as "Approved" on the back end.

- Tag Jackie and Catherine on Trello as follows from the info on the cover sheet:

@jwallace45 @cbratcher2- Payment Verified

- Jon Doe
- ABC Car Repair
- 423-555-5555- John (contact)
- \$150.00

- Move the card to the Payments Board

- If the shop is requesting a check or this is a reimbursement, let Catherine know on the card.